

Chapter Twenty-Two

Other Topics of Note

*Proximity to Elite · Oppression Olympics ·
The Problem with Communism*

This is the final chapter of the framework. Three topics that don't fit the previous categories but are essential: Proximity to Elite / Classism (a vastly better explanation of class than classic classist theory), Oppression Olympics (a joke that became a thought experiment), and The Problem with Communism (communism as rearrangement of matrices rather than emancipation).

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CHAPTER 22 OF AN ONGOING FRAMEWORK · THE FINAL CHAPTER

Other Topics of Note

This is the final chapter of the framework. Three topics that do not fit into the Fundamental Matrices, Intersectional Matrices, or Aggregations categories but are essential to the framework’s analytical power: **Proximity to Elite / Classism** (a measurement concept), **Oppression Olympics** (a joke that became a thought experiment), and **The Problem with Communism** (a critique of movements that intend to dismantle systemic oppression but end up rearranging the matrices instead).

READING NOTE

Same convention as Chapters 1 through 21. Every paragraph is written to be tweetable. This chapter does not have fill-in-the-blanks because the three topics are analytical concepts rather than lived matrices. The framework’s point in this chapter is to give you three tools: a better way to measure class, a thought experiment for designing society, and a critique of the most influential emancipatory movement in modern history.

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TOPIC 1 · A MEASUREMENT CONCEPT

1. Proximity to Elite / Classism

Proximity to Elite is a measurement concept. If you mapped a person's position across all the Stratification residues produced by all fundamental matrices simultaneously, the resulting composite position is their Proximity to Elite. This is a vastly better explanation of class than classic classist theory.

Classic classist theory, from Marx through Weber to Bourdieu, measures class by a single axis or a small set of axes. Marx measured class by relation to the means of production — bourgeois or proletarian. Weber measured class by market position — the ability to command resources in the market. Bourdieu measured class by cultural capital — the tastes, dispositions, and knowledge that mark the person as belonging to a particular class.

But the framework has shown that stratification is produced by **multiple matrices simultaneously**. Rankism stratifies by position. Cisheteropatriarchy stratifies by gender and sexuality. Coloniality stratifies by colonial origin. Enclosure stratifies by property. Ethnic Majoritarianism stratifies by ethnic group. Territorialism stratifies by territorial origin. Somatic Normativity stratifies by bodily capacity and appearance. Productivism stratifies by productivity. Religious Dominance stratifies by religious identity. Retributivism stratifies by criminal status. Adultism stratifies by age. Kinship Normativity stratifies by blood and marriage. Amatonormativity stratifies by couple-form status. Meritism stratifies by significance.

A person's class is not their relation to the means of production alone. A person's class is their **composite position across ALL stratification residues**. The person who is male (above in Cisheteropatriarchy), adult (above in Adultism), married with children (above in Kinship Normativity and Amatonormativity), able-bodied (above in Somatic Normativity), light-skinned (above in Coloniality / Colorism), employed (above in Productivism), property-owning (above in Enclosure), ethnic majority (above in Ethnic Majoritarianism), indigene (above in Territorialism), mainstream Christian or Muslim (above in Religious Dominance), senior in rank (above in Rankism), law-abiding (above in Retributivism), English-speaking (above in Coloniality / Linguicism), cisgender heterosexual (above in Cisheteropatriarchy), and significant (above in Meritism) is at **maximum Proximity to Elite**.

The person who is the opposite on every axis — female, child, unmarried, childless, disabled, dark-skinned, unemployed, propertyless, ethnic minority, non-indigene, traditional religion practitioner, junior in rank, criminalised, non-English-speaking, LGBTQ+, and insignificant — is at **maximum distance from Elite**. Between these extremes, every Nigerian occupies a composite position that is more or less proximate to Elite on each axis.

This composite is a vastly better explanation of class because it captures the multi-axis nature of privilege and oppression that single-axis class theory cannot. The Marxist who says 'class is about

relation to the means of production' cannot explain why the male worker earns more than the female worker with the same relation to the means of production. The Weberian who says 'class is about market position' cannot explain why the light-skinned Nigerian with the same market position as the dark-skinned Nigerian receives better treatment. The Bourdieusian who says 'class is about cultural capital' cannot explain why the able-bodied Nigerian with the same cultural capital as the disabled Nigerian receives more opportunities.

Proximity to Elite explains all of these, because it maps the person's position across every stratification residue simultaneously. The Nigerian woman who is well-educated, employed, and property-owning (high on Enclosure and Productivism axes) but who is also female (below in Cisheteropatriarchy), dark-skinned (below in Coloniality / Colorism), and non-indigene in her state of residence (below in Territorialism) is at a composite position that single-axis class theory would classify as 'middle class' but that Proximity to Elite classifies as partially elite, partially oppressed. The composite is the better explanation because it captures the reality that the person is privileged on some axes and oppressed on others, and that the oppression on some axes can cancel the privilege on others.

The framework's point is not that Proximity to Elite replaces class analysis. The framework's point is that Proximity to Elite **is** class analysis, done properly. Class is not one axis. Class is the composite of all axes. The person who understands their Proximity to Elite understands their actual class position, not the simplified position that single-axis theory assigns them.

TOPIC 2 · A JOKE THAT BECAME A THOUGHT EXPERIMENT

2. Oppression Olympics

This one is a joke. One day, the framework's author had a thought: what if we intersected every fundamental oppressive system and identified that specific person who is a subject to all of them? We would have found the most oppressed person in the world.

But it's a joke. Please do not take it out of context. Determining who is the most oppressed of them all does sound funny. The image of a panel of judges at the Oppression Olympics, holding up scorecards for each contestant's suffering, is absurd — and the absurdity is the point. Oppression is not a competition. Suffering is not a sport. The framework does not endorse the ranking of oppressed people by degree of oppression.

But the author once heard someone say something that turned the joke into a thought experiment. The person said: if we redesigned society with this kind of person in mind, our society would be a vastly better place. That is the serious point. If you design society for the person who is at maximum distance from Elite on every axis simultaneously — the person who is female, child, unmarried, childless, disabled, dark-skinned, unemployed, propertyless, ethnic minority, non-indigene, traditional religion practitioner, junior in rank, criminalised, LGBTQ+, non-English-speaking, and suicidal — you would design a society that works for everyone.

This is because a society that works for the most oppressed works for all. If the disabled, dark-skinned, non-indigene, ethnic-minority, LGBTQ+, non-English-speaking woman can access healthcare, education, employment, housing, political participation, and dignity, then everyone above her on any axis can also access these things. The design principle is simple: design for the bottom, and the top takes care of itself. Design for the top, and the bottom falls through.

This is the framework's version of the Rawlsian veil of ignorance. John Rawls, in *A Theory of Justice* (1971), asked: what principles of justice would you choose if you did not know your position in society? The framework modifies the question: what principles would you choose if you knew you would be the most oppressed person in society? The difference is that Rawls asks you to imagine you might be anyone, while the framework asks you to imagine you would be everyone's subject simultaneously.

The framework's version is more demanding than Rawls's, because it requires you to design for the person who is oppressed by every matrix at once, not just by the matrix you happened to draw in the veil lottery. But the framework's version is also more hopeful, because it tells you that if you get the design right for this person, you have gotten it right for everyone. The Oppression Olympics is a joke. The design principle is not.

TOPIC 3 · A CRITIQUE

3. The Problem with Communism

Based on what we have spoken about so far, it is apparent that communism is just a rearrangement of the fundamental matrices and not really emancipation. The framework's point is not that communism is worse than capitalism. The framework's point is that communism is not the alternative to capitalism that it claims to be, because it does not dismantle the fundamental matrices that produce oppression. It rearranges them.

Communism tries to dismantle Enclosure (by nationalising property) but intends to do it through State Sovereignty and Retributivism while leaving Rankism, Cisheteropatriarchy, Productivism, and basically every other fundamental matrix intact either through will or ignorance. The simultaneity principle from Chapter 20 applies: you cannot dismantle one matrix while leaving the others intact, because the others will regenerate the matrix you dismantled.

An example is China. China claims capitalism is bad but ended up with State Capitalism and one of the most powerful Elite Classes in the world. China's president is basically the man with the most power in the world since he's basically a dictator with the resources of a superpower — he doesn't even have to pretend at democracy like the other superpowers. China's 'communism' is the rearrangement of fundamental matrices around the party-state rather than around the market, but the matrices themselves remain.

Let us trace which matrices communism addresses and which it leaves intact. **Enclosure**: partially addressed, by nationalising property. But the state becomes the property owner, so Enclosure is not dismantled — it is transferred from private to state hands. The subject still cannot access resources without state permission. **State Sovereignty**: not addressed, in fact intensified. The communist state claims more authority than the capitalist state, because it claims authority over the economy as well as the polity.

Retributivism: not addressed, in fact intensified. The communist state punishes dissent more severely than the capitalist state, because dissent threatens the party's monopoly. **Rankism**: not addressed, in fact intensified. The party hierarchy replaces the corporate hierarchy, but the ranking remains. The party secretary ranks above the member; the Central Committee ranks above the party secretary; the General Secretary ranks above all.

Productivism: not addressed, in fact intensified. The communist state demands productivity from every citizen, often through compulsory labour. **Cisheteropatriarchy**: not addressed. Communist states have historically maintained gender hierarchy, despite rhetorical commitments to gender equality. **Adultism**: not addressed. Communist states have historically maintained age hierarchy through the party and the family.

Religious Dominance: partially addressed, by suppressing organised religion. But the state itself becomes the object of worship, with the party leader as the deity and the party ideology as the theology. Religious Dominance is not dismantled — it is transferred from church to party.

Coloniality: not addressed. Communist states have historically adopted Western industrialisation models, Western technology, and Western epistemic standards, reproducing the coloniality of knowledge and power.

The result is not emancipation but rearrangement. The matrices are reorganised around the party-state rather than around the market, but the matrices themselves remain. The worker who was exploited by the capitalist is now exploited by the party. The citizen who was policed by the capitalist state is now policed by the communist state. The subject who was ranked by the corporate hierarchy is now ranked by the party hierarchy. The oppression continues; only the enforcer has changed.

The framework's point is that any movement that intends to dismantle systemic oppression must address **ALL** fundamental matrices simultaneously (the simultaneity principle from Chapter 20). Communism addresses one matrix (Enclosure) partially, while leaving seventeen others intact. The result is the regeneration of the dismantled matrix through the remaining ones — the state becomes the new property owner (Enclosure regenerated through State Sovereignty), the party becomes the new elite (Rankism regenerated through the party hierarchy), and the worker remains exploited (Productivism intact).

The framework's goal is not rearrangement but **abolition** — the dismantling of ALL matrices, not the reorganisation of some. The framework does not endorse capitalism. The framework does not endorse communism. The framework endorses abolition: the simultaneous dismantling of all eighteen fundamental matrices, the dissolution of all six intersections, and the elimination of all five aggregations. Anything less is rearrangement, not emancipation.

CONCLUSION

4. Conclusion: The Framework Complete

This is the final section of the final chapter. The framework is now complete. Twenty-two chapters have been written, covering: the architecture chapter (Chapter 1) that defined the grammar — the goal of abolition, the requirements for systemic oppression, the distinction between fundamental, intersectional, and aggregation, the four stages of a matrix, and the five domains of domination.

Eighteen fundamental matrix chapters (Chapters 2-19), each running a specific matrix through the five domains with Nigerian context: Rankism, Adultism, Kinship Normativity, Cisheteropatriarchy, Religious Dominance, Enclosure, Productivism, Invasion, Settler Colonialism (as a warning), Coloniality, Somatic Normativity, Retributivism, Amatonormativity, Compulsory Existence / Suicidism, Meritism / The Significant, Ethnic Majoritarianism, Territorialism, and State Sovereignty / Statism.

The intersectional matrices chapter (Chapter 20) showed what combinations produce that individuals do not: Capitalism, The Romantic/Sexual Script, Familism, Nationalism, Colonialism/Imperialism, and Theocratic Moralism. The aggregations chapter (Chapter 21) showed what accumulated weight produces: Beauty Standards, Manufactured Loneliness, Social Death / Invisibility, Burnout / Exhaustion, and Accelerated Slow Death.

And this chapter (Chapter 22) covered three topics that complete the framework: Proximity to Elite / Classism (class as composite position across all stratification residues), Oppression Olympics (design for the most oppressed and you design for all), and The Problem with Communism (rearrangement is not abolition).

The framework's ultimate goal, stated in Chapter 1 and pursued through every subsequent chapter, is **zero** — the point at which all oppressive systems have been abolished and suppressed in perpetuity. The framework's own words, from the outline that began this project: 'Zero is not utopia. It is only the absence of the foolishness that has caused us so much suffering. But the people that will go from zero to utopia we first need a world absent of oppressive systems. That is the eventual goal of this framework: Abolition. But before abolition, we must have understanding.'

The reader who has filled in every blank across twenty-two chapters has located themselves inside every matrix, every intersection, every aggregation. They have named the moment they forgot they could rebel. They have named the form of death they are most afraid of. They have identified the matrices they recognise most strongly in their own situation. They have noticed the aggregate weight rather than any single source. They have imagined what would change if even one contributing matrix were removed.

That sight is the beginning of abolition. The framework is now complete. The work of abolition begins.

The framework ends where it began: with the understanding that before abolition, we must have understanding. The twenty-two chapters of this framework are the understanding. What comes next is the abolition.

References

This chapter draws on the theoretical framework established in Chapter 1 and developed across Chapters 2-21. Key sources for the three topics:

1. Bourdieu, P. (1984). *Distinction: A Social Critique of the Judgement of Taste* (R. Nice, Trans.). Harvard University Press. (Source for the cultural-capital analysis of class that Proximity to Elite extends.)
2. Marx, K. (1976). *Capital: A Critique of Political Economy* (Vol. 1; B. Fowkes, Trans.). Penguin. (Original work published 1867. Source for the relation-to-means-of-production analysis of class that Proximity to Elite replaces.)
3. Rawls, J. (1971). *A Theory of Justice*. Harvard University Press. (Source for the veil of ignorance that the Oppression Olympics thought experiment modifies.)
4. Weber, M. (1978). *Economy and Society* (G. Roth & C. Wittich, Eds.; 2 vols.). University of California Press. (Original work published 1922. Source for the market-position analysis of class that Proximity to Elite extends.)
5. Gilmore, R. W. (2007). *Golden Gulag: Prisons, Surplus, Crisis, and Opposition in Globalizing California*. University of California Press. (Source for the abolitionist analysis that the Problem with Communism critique extends.)
6. Fisher, M. (2009). *Capitalist Realism: Is There No Alternative?* Zero Books. (Source for the analysis of Capitalist Realism that applies to both capitalism and communism as rearrangements rather than alternatives.)